



Q.18) The condition of internal migrants despite them being Indian citizens, is often compared to international refugees as they usually end up without a social protection net at the destination region. Critically examine in context of migrant's crisis caused due to Covid -19. Also, suggest ways and means to tackle the vulnerabilities of this section of the society. (15 Marks, 250 Words)

आंतरिक प्रवासियों की स्थिति, उनके भारतीय नागरिक होने के बावजूद उन्हें अक्सर अंतरराष्ट्रीय शरणार्थियों से तुलना की जाती है क्योंकि वे आमतौर पर गंतव्य स्थान तक बिना सामाजिक सुरक्षा के ही विचरण करते हैं। कोविड - 19 के कारण होने वाले प्रवासी संकट के संदर्भ में इसकी चर्चा करें। इसके अलावा, समाज के इस वर्ग की समस्याओं से निपटने के तरीके और उपाय सुझाएं। (15 अंक, 250 शब्द)

Internal migrants are the ~~workers~~ <sup>citizen residents</sup> of different states settling in another state for economic, social or environmental reasons. Census 2011 suggests India has 45% internal migrants. Their position is considered to be akin to international refugees as:

1. They possess no clear political rights in the new locations.
2. They are poorly treated in the region due to regionalism, son of soil tendencies.
3. Lack of portability of entitlements and benefits that are tied to ration cards.

4. Poor living conditions especially for the urban poor - ghettoisation, housing, water, etc.
5. Lack of job security is another major concern. Education opportunity is also scarce.

In Covid crisis this was all the more visible as:

1. Lack of homes for proper social-distancing.
2. Concerns of health and livelihood.
3. Many adopted method of walking to their hometowns due to lack of social security.

Steps taken

- Internal Migrant Workers Act, 1979
- Recently proposed One Nation One Ration Card.

Ways & means to tackle their challenges

1. Need for collection of data about these migrants with clear identification.
2. Skill mapping database of these migrants. eg. UP Govt's initiatives



3. Need for portability of all benefits across the nation.  
eg. Election Commission proposes voting remotely through Aadhar seeding.
  4. Rental Housing complexes to be created for affordability.
  5. Ensuring education of children of migrant workers  
eg. Gujarat Govt. has formed hostels for such children & special textbooks.
  6. Ensure seamless travel opportunities to prevent exodus. eg. UDAN connectivity.
  7. RURBAN mission to prevent stress migration from the source itself.
- Thus, policy initiatives must be taken to reduce the distress faced by such migrants.

Feedback (For OFFICE use only)

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| Structure               |  | Content |  |
| Question Interpretation |  | Total : |  |